

Raptor Center Operating Money Flew Off With Hugo

By PAT BORDEN GUBBINS
Staff Writer

In the aftermath of hurricane and flood, the Carolina Raptor Center is flying on one wing.

One large flight cage — the last step in the recovery for releasable birds — was smashed by three large trees. It will cost \$1,500 to replace.

"Our biggest problem, other than damage to the cages, was we had to close the Raptor Center," said Executive Director Pat Marcum.



Marcum

"All our programs were canceled for two or three weeks, with schools closed and the park closed. So we had no income for several weeks. With a small organization like the Raptor Center, that's devastating. We lost \$5,000. In fact, I'm struggling to find the money to pay salaries with this month."

But for the Carolina Raptor Center, which takes in injured and orphaned birds of prey, survival has always been a struggle, she said. "I think with the volunteers we have and the wonderful support we've always had, we'll make it through."

Marcum saw plenty of evidence of this support after the hurricane struck. The Raptor Center was without water, power or telephone. The next day, volunteer Mike Morgan drove from his home near Wilmington to deliver a large generator to run the pump on the well used by the center.

Other volunteers walked a mile, climbing over trees, to reach the center. They worked all day Friday and Saturday to help clear away fallen trees and limbs.

"We had 20 or more doing back-breaking work, dragging trees and debris," Marcum said. "It's going to continue a long time because we are knee-deep in debris at the Raptor Center. But we are open again. We opened this (past)



MEREDITH HEDDEN

Executive Director Pat Marcum says the Raptor Center suffered about \$7,000 in damage and lost revenues, including the destruction of a large flight cage.

weekend, finally. It's just not as pretty as we would like it to be."

Want To Help?

Send donations to Carolina Raptor Center, P.O. Box 16443, Charlotte, N.C. 28297. The center is at Latta Plantation Park on Sample Road off Beattles Ford Road, about 12 miles from uptown Charlotte. The center is open to the public from noon to 5 p.m. Wednesday through Sunday.

new outlook

WINDOW COVERINGS

60% OFF*

Mini Blinds & Micro Blinds

CUSTOM DESIGN RESIDENTIAL COMMERCIAL

- Custom Draperies
- Top Treatments
- Bedspreads
- Dust Ruffles
- Balloon Shades

Kirsch Drapery Hardware

- Swag Holders
- Knot Holders



SUNWORTHY